

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

2001-01-14

To the conference marking the inauguration

1 of the international Teaching center building
2 dearly loved friends,
3 we are filled with a sense of triumph as we reflect on the significance of
4 the occupation by the international Teaching center of its permanent seat 349.1

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351 m e S a g e f r o m T h e u n i v e r s a l h o u s e o f j u s t i c e
352 770on the mountain of the lord. This occasion marks the beginning of what
353 future generations will regard as a splendid chapter in the annals of our
354 faith.

what joy that the hands of the cause of god 'Alí-Akbar furútan and

355 'Alí-m uḡammad varqá are able to participate in these proceedings! we ac-
356 knowledge the great debt of gratitude owed to them and to the departed ones of their
exalted rank for so much of what we have come to celebrate.

357 And how fitting it is that the continental counselors and their deputies
358 from the five continents are here to witness such an auspicious beginning!

359 The attendance of the Auxiliary board members is so unusual a feature of
360 the gathering that we are impelled to address our remarks particularly to them.
indeed, on no occasion in the past have the major constituents of the

361 institution of the counselors ever assembled in the holy land.

with joyous hearts, we extend to every member of the Auxiliary boards

362 a special and loving welcome. we hail this opportunity to greet and thank

363 these officers of an institution the crucial importance of whose vital role in the
progress of the cause of bahá'u'lláh is increasingly demonstrated as the

364 divine plan unfolds. may we not at such a moment invoke, above all, the
365 memory of him in whose divinely inspired mind the conception of Auxiliary boards
took shape? up until the time of his passing in 1957, Shoghi
366 effendi had called for the appointment of seventy-two such officers, who
367 were evenly divided between the two boards on each of the five continents;
368 with the institutional evolution that has taken place since then, the number has
increased to nearly one thousand.
369 with the international Teaching center having settled into its position
370 at the heart of a ramified, global institution, we can readily recognize the fruition of
the system set to extend into the future the specialized functions of propagation and
protection originally assigned to the hands of the
371 cause—a system that has derived impetus from the guidance and example of these
irreplaceable appointees of Shoghi effendi. This achievement is in
372 itself a thrilling indication of how well the cause is faring.

in you, the Auxiliary board members here assembled, is reflected the

373 whole world of humanity. you hail from far-flung geographic regions and
374 cultural backgrounds that make you truly representative of a cross-section of the
human family. your coming here both reaffirms the existence of a
375 dynamic, global community and signalizes the possibilities for an advance in the
process of entry by troops far beyond any record yet established. in 350.2

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351 2000–2001 • The Twelvemonth Plan

352 771this latter regard, the value of your immediate future services cannot be
353 overestimated.

The world's crying need for the divine prescriptions is made plain by

354 the ills afflicting society at every level in all parts of the planet. we must be
355 swift in ministering to this need. doing so largely depends upon the revo-
356 lutionary vision, the creative drive and systematic effort of Auxiliary board
357 members and their assistants, who prompt and encourage individuals, institutions
and communities to act with dispatch, constancy and enthusiasm. Their operation at the
grassroots, at the very wellspring, of individual and collective activity, makes manageable

the fulfillment of this pressing need.

in contemplating the sublime purpose that has brought us together on

358 this day, we find ourselves without words to describe adequately our wonderment
at the evidences of bahá'u'lláh's handiwork. we stand too close to

359 the moment to comprehend the magnitude of what has been so amazingly
accomplished. but to ponder the circumstances attending seminal happen-

360 ings of the past is to awaken in us all some sense of appreciation for their wonderful
consequences in our time. The revelation of the Tablet of car-

361 mel, the interment of the remains of bahá'u'lláh's martyred forerunner in

362 the mausoleum constructed by the beloved master, the creation by our dear

363 guardian of the Arc on the hill of god—reflections on just such historic

364 landmarks illumine our understanding and evoke gratitude in our hearts.

The journeys that brought you to these sacred precincts have launched

365 you on spiritual adventures that will be celebrated in times to come as hav-ing
imparted a new impetus to the advancement of the cause. This is the

366 hope and expectation we cherish. for as you drink deep of the rarefied spirit

367 of the holy Shrines and imbibe the guidance that will flow from the con-

368 sultations in which you will participate, there can be no doubt that you will find
yourselves endowed with a new confidence, a new power. with so rich

369 an endowment, how can your endeavors fail? most surely, you will bring

370 a rejuvenated fervor and a reconsecrated effort to the compelling civilizing tasks you
have accepted to perform at this potent juncture in the evolution of our glorious faith.

our supplications are intermingled with yours that the blessed beauty

371 may abundantly confirm you in his service.

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Conference of the Continental Counselors

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]